

Monte Verde Criminal Police
Case 1114



Envelope B

Victor's safe

Keep this envelope sealed. Open it only when you have
cracked Victor's safe in the game.

7 documents inside, B1 to B7

*For whoever prints this: don't read the pages that follow. Slide them straight into an envelope
with this sheet on top, and seal it.*

Contents of the wall safe

Opened at 03:40 with the code found by the detectives, in the presence of Mrs Valmont.

1. €220,000 in used notes, the casino's float. Bank bands intact.
2. Deeds to the Velvet Crown Casino, dated 14 November 1981.
3. Mr Valmont's black leather notebook, pages 1 to 15 used.
4. Tucked inside the notebook: a worn playing card with handwriting on the back.
5. A handwritten draft of a new will, with a letter from the notary.
6. A witness summons from the Tribunal of Monte Verde: *State v. A. G.*, hearing of 9 March 2004.
Witness for the prosecution: Victor Valmont.
7. A framed four-leaf clover.

Mrs Valmont had never seen inside the safe. Nothing appears to be missing.

Maitre Hugo Lenoir, Notary
12 Rue des Palmiers, Monte Verde

Tuesday 10 November

Dear Mr Valmont,

As requested, I have reserved Monday 16 November at 10:00 for the signing of your new will. Until it is signed, your will of 2017 remains valid, under which Mrs Isabella Valmont is your sole heir.

As you asked, all correspondence on this matter goes to the casino and not to your home. Please bring the full name and particulars of the new principal beneficiary, which you preferred not to put in writing.

Yours faithfully,
H. Lenoir

My last will. Draft, for Lenoir on Monday.

- 1. To my wife Isabella: the villa at Cap Rouge and twenty thousand a month for life.*
- 2. To Marco Santoro: nothing. He knows why.*
- 3. The Velvet Crown, entire, to the only child of the man I wronged in March 2004. Restitution: too late, but in full.*

V. V.

The draft is not signed.

11

3 Nov. Count short again, the third time since September. Forty thousand. Only Marco touches the money between the tables and the Cage. Deal with it after the gala.

12

7 Nov. Leopold owes 380,000 now. Told him: pay by Monday, or I go to the medical board about the prescriptions he writes for himself.

9 Nov. Petrov: sixty million, third offer. Over my dead body. And I. and N. at the Aurora on Thursday. I'm old, not blind.

Celeste wants to run to Petrov. The contract says three more years. I'll hold her to every day of it.

13

Victor wrote this page in cards. Write a letter under each card as you work it out.

7 ♠	8 ♥	5 ♥	3 ♦	7 ♥	5 ♠	5 ♥	Q ♠	J ♦	7 ♥	8 ♥	4 ♣	2 ♠
6 ♠	7 ♠	6 ♠	7 ♦	3 ♥	8 ♥	9 ♥	Q ♥	4 ♥	A ♦	9 ♥	6 ♠	9 ♦
8 ♠	A ♠	J ♣	4 ♥	5 ♥	5 ♠	5 ♦	K ♥	Q ♠	K ♦	5 ♠	2 ♠	2 ♠
6 ♥	2 ♣											

14

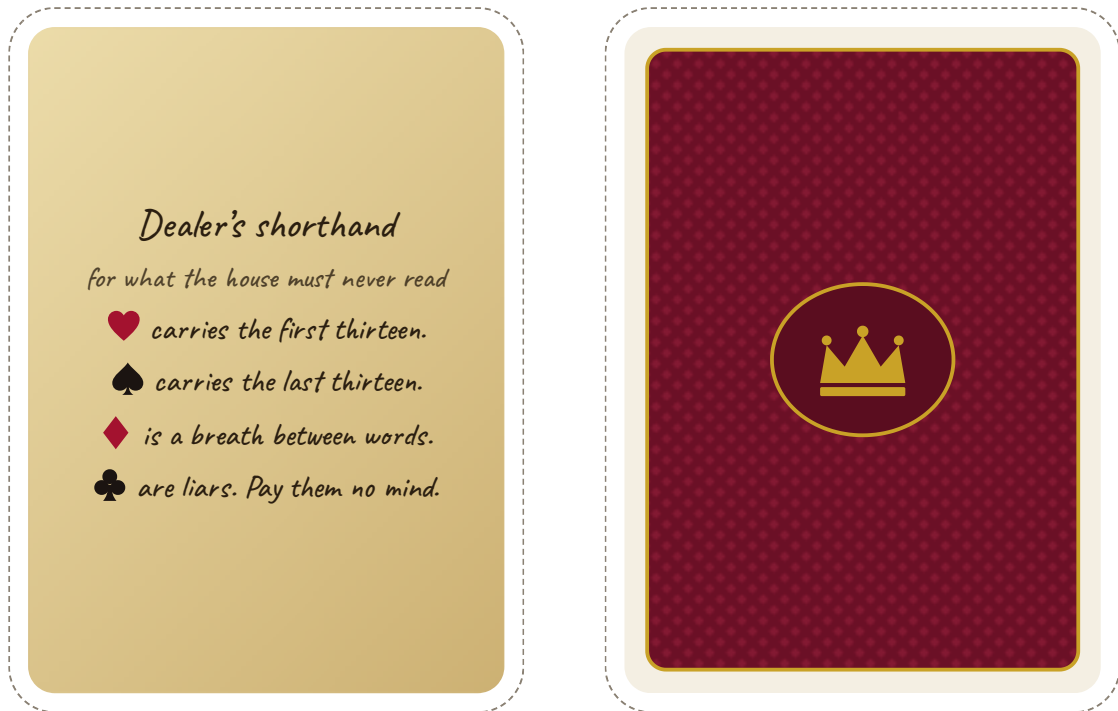
Same hands. Same smile. Even the same trick with the ring. After twenty-two years I'd know it anywhere.

Monday: Lenoir. Then the whole truth about March 2004. Those marked cards were never his. I let an innocent man die in a cell to protect the name of this house.

The Last Hand was always going to come for me.

The dealer's shorthand

Found between pages 12 and 13, written on the back of a card from a very old casino deck.



Cut out both sides along the dashed lines and glue them back to back to hold the real thing.

Crown Office door: unlock events

Saturday 14 November to Sunday 15 November

Time	Keycard
19:48:10	V. VALMONT
21:12:44	V. VALMONT
22:01:05	M. SANTORO
23:11:31	I. VALMONT
23:29:18	V. VALMONT
00:04:52	M. SANTORO

How the lock works

Only unlocks are recorded. The door locks itself when it closes, and leaving the office is not logged.

Four cards open this door: Victor Valmont's, Isabella Valmont's, Marco Santoro's, and a master card kept in the security office safe. The master card was not used tonight.

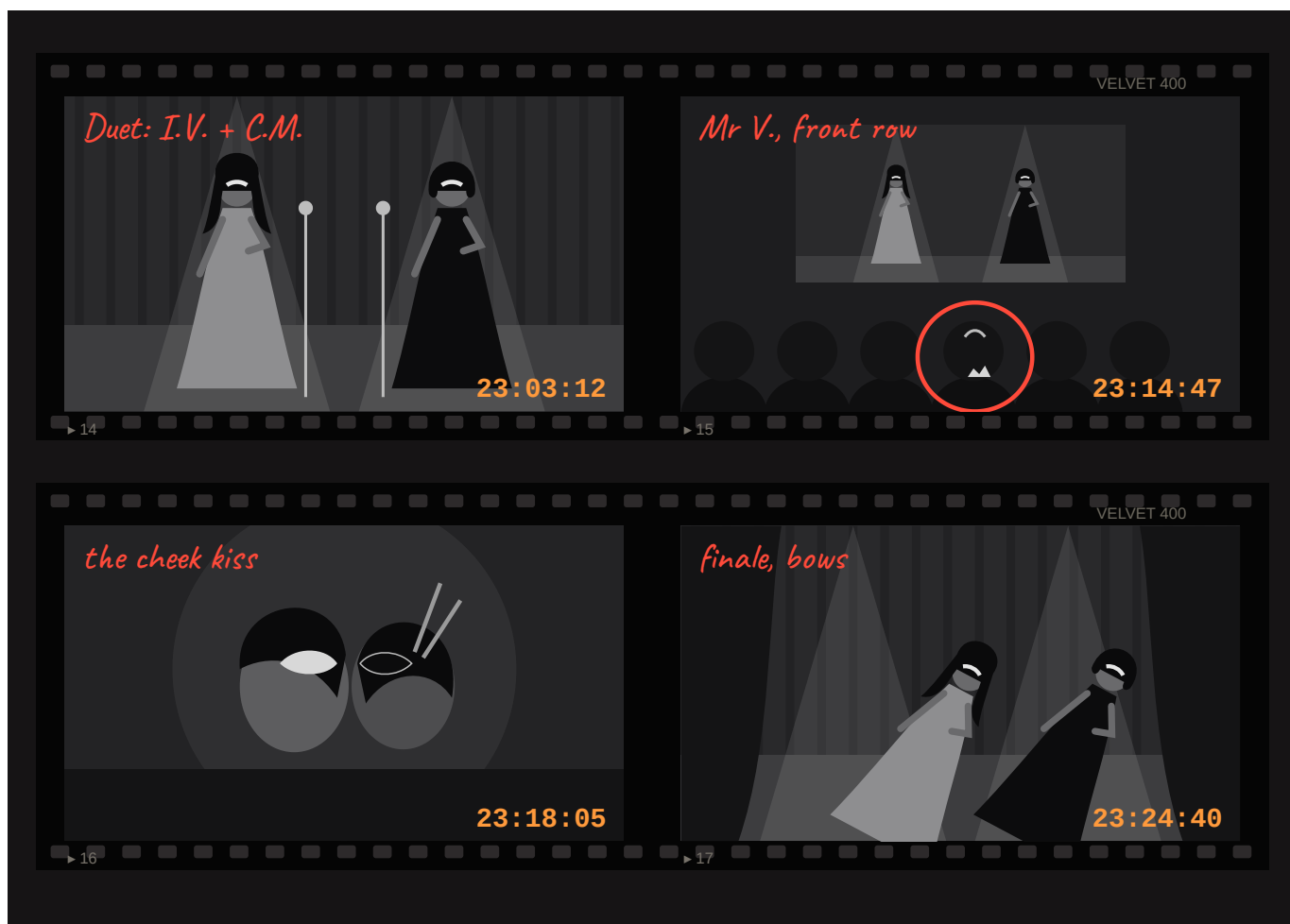


Technician's notes, camera 04

19:48, 21:12	V. Valmont, alone.
22:01	M. Santoro, carrying a small box. Leaves at 22:02.
23:11:29	Unidentified person comes up the stairs. Enters 23:11:31, leaves 23:14:02.
23:29	V. Valmont, alone.
00:04	M. Santoro, with the cash bag.

Measured against the height strip on the door frame, the 23:11 visitor stands 1.83 m, give or take 2 cm, including footwear. Black tuxedo, black gloves, white full-face Bauta mask. The card is held to the reader in the **left** hand. Nothing visible is carried in or out.

About sixty white Bauta masks were handed out at the entrance to guests who arrived without one. Staff wore black half-masks.



Rémy Laurent, official gala photographer. His camera clock was checked against the casino's master clock at 20:00 and was correct to the second. The grease-pencil notes are his.